1. Basic facts

Full name and other names

- **Full name:** Batukeshwar Dutt (also spelled Batukeshwar Dutta or B. K. Dutt / B. K. Dutta) | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "Batukeshwar Dutta — also known as B. K. Dutta, Battu, and Mohan — was a son of Goshtha Bihari Dutta."
- **Nicknames and party alias:** Known among comrades as "Battu" and used the party alias "Mohan" | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "Batukeshwar Dutt whose party alias was 'Mohan', was born on November 18, 1910, in Bengal's Burdwan district"

Born (date, place) / Died (date, place, how)

- **Born (majority version):** 18 November 1910 in Oari (also spelled Onari or Oadi) village, Khandaghosh, Purba Bardhaman (Burdwan) district, Bengal Presidency (now West Bengal) (see Section 4 for conflicting 1911 birth year and Kanpur birthplace claims) | Batukeshwar Dutt Biography | > "Batukeshwar Dutt was born on 18 November 1910 in the village of Oari, in the Khandaghosh area of the Burdwan district"
- **Died:** 20 July 1965 (two hours after midnight on 19–20 July) at the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) in New Delhi, from cancer, aged 54 | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "died two hours after the midnight of 19—20 July 1965 in the AIIMS hospital in Delhi after a long illness." and The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "Dutt died of cancer on July 20, 1965, in Delhi."
- **Cremation place:** Cremated on 21 July 1965 at Hussainiwala near Firozpur in Punjab, beside the memorials of Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev Thapar, and Shivaram Rajguru | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "He was cremated in Hussainiwala near Firozepur in Punjab where the bodies of his comrades Bhagat Singh, Shivaram Rajguru and Sukhdev Thapar were also cremated"

Family, education, work

- **Parents:** Son of Goshtha Bihari Dutt (Dutta) and Kamini Devi, in a Bengali Kayastha family | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "born on November 18, 1910, in Bengal's Burdwan district to Goshtha Bihari Dutt and Kamini Devi."
- **Brother:** Vishveshwar Dutt, with whom Batukeshwar lived in Jakkanpur, Patna, after his 1938 release | Liberation | > "released on 8 September 1938 from Bankipur Jail abd started living with his brother Vishveshwar Dutt at his house in Jakkanpur."
- **Spouse and daughter:** Married Anjali Dutt (sources disagree on whether they married in 1937 or November 1947; see Section 4) and had one daughter, Bharati Dutta Bagchi | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "After India gained independence, he married Anjali in November 1947... He was survived by his only daughter, Bharti Dutta Bagchi, in Patna"
- **Schooling in Kanpur:** Grew up in Kanpur (then Cawnpore, United Provinces), where he attended the Theosophical High School and graduated from Pandit Prithi Nath (P. P. N.) High School | Batukeshwar Dutt Biography | > "He was educated there, attending the Theosophical High School and P. P. N. (Pandit Prithi Nath) High School, from which he graduated."
- **Post-independence work:** Worked in Patna as a cigarette company agent, sold biscuits

and bread, worked at times as a tourist guide, tried starting a bus transport business, and served briefly on the Bihar Legislative Council in 1963 | The Wire (July 2020) | > "Batukeshwar Dutt had to work as a cigarette company agent, shuttling between Patna's tobacco shops, or sell biscuits and bread for a living."

Groups and organisations they belonged to

- **Tarun Sangh (Kanpur):** Youth flood-relief volunteer group in Kanpur where Dutt and Bhagat Singh worked together during the 1924 Ganges floods | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "When Kanpur was flooded in 1924, both Singh and Dutt volunteered to be a part of 'Tarun Sangh'- formed to help the flood victims."
- **Kanpur Gymnastic Club:** Formed in Kanpur with Vijay Kumar Sinha, Ajoy Ghosh, and Surendra Nath Pandey, producing a handwritten magazine named *Kranti* | Liberation | > "along with Vijay Kumar Sinha, Ajay Ghosh and Surendra Nath Pandey, formed the Kanpur Gymnastic Club and also started a hand-written magazine, Kranti."
- **Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) / Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA):** Joined in Kanpur in 1924 and served as an active member and bomb-maker | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "He learned about bomb-making while working for the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA)."
- **Naujawan Bharat Sabha:** Listed as one of Dutt's revolutionary youth organisations | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "Organization(s): Hindustan Socialist Republican Association, Naujawan Bharat Sabha, Communist Consolidation"
- **Workers and Peasants Party (Bengal) & Howrah Scavengers' Union:** Worked in Calcutta writing Hindi posters and organising Hindi-speaking migrant workers | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "he participated in the activities of Workers and Peasant Party... and was also briefly engaged with the Howrah branch of Scavengers' union of Bengal."
- **Communist Consolidation (Cellular Jail):** Marxist study group founded by about 35 political prisoners inside the Andaman Cellular Jail, where Dutt wrote for the handwritten magazine *The Call* | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "he also played an important role in establishing Communist Consolidation... Dutt also used to write the handwritten magazine titled 'The Call'"
- **Provincial Navyuvak Sangh (United Provinces):** Formed at a May 1939 conference in Mukar village, Unnao, presided over by Dutt | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "The conference was held under the president-ship of Batukeshwarr Dutt and ended with the formation of the provincial Navyuak Sangh."

The 10 most important events in his life (in date order)

1. **Meeting Bhagat Singh in Kanpur and joining the HRA (1924):** Met Bhagat Singh in Kanpur in 1924, joined the Hindustan Republican Association, and volunteered with him during the Kanpur floods | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "He was a close associate of freedom fighters such as Chandra Shekhar Azad and Bhagat Singh, the latter of whom he met in Cawnpore in 1924."
2. **Organising Hindi-speaking workers in Calcutta and hiding Bhagat Singh in Oari (1925–1928):** After the 1925 Kakori arrests, Dutt worked with the Workers and Peasants Party in Calcutta and later sheltered Bhagat Singh in his ancestral village of Oari after the

December 1928 Saunders shooting | Liberation | > "Dutt took him to his ancestral village Oadi where both stayed for some time, but the police got wind of their whereabouts and they went underground."

3. **Central Legislative Assembly bombing and arrest in Delhi (8 April 1929):** Threw two low-intensity bombs with Bhagat Singh from the Visitors' Gallery of the Central Legislative Assembly in Delhi, tossed red HSRA leaflets, shouted *"Inquilab Zindabad!"*, and surrendered for arrest | The Tribune (Jan 2025) | > "Bhagat Singh (21) of Lahore and his friend, Batukeshwar Dutt (19) of Burdwan, had courted arrest after throwing a bomb in the Central Legislative Assembly on April 8, 1929."
4. **Joint courtroom statement and life sentence (6–12 June 1929):** On 6 June 1929, defence lawyer Asaf Ali read out Singh and Dutt's statement explaining their protest; on 12 June 1929, both were sentenced to transportation for life | Mint | > "The tide of public opinion suddenly shifted when the defence lawyer, Asaf Ali read out a statement on behalf of Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt on 6 June 1929." and Batukeshwar Dutt Biography | > "On 12 June 1929 the Sessions Judge at Delhi convicted them... and sentenced both to transportation for life."
5. **Prison hunger strike for political prisoner rights (June–October 1929):** Began a prolonged hunger strike with Bhagat Singh on 15 June 1929 demanding better food, books, newspapers, and political prisoner status | Batukeshwar Dutt Biography | > "On 15 June 1929 — three days after conviction — they began a hunger strike demanding that Indian political prisoners be treated on the same terms as European convicts"
6. **Acquittal in the Lahore Conspiracy Case and separation from Bhagat Singh (1930):** Acquitted of the Lahore Conspiracy charges for lack of evidence while Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru were sentenced to death; Dutt was sent to Multan and Salem jails | Liberation | > "Dutt was acquitted in the Lahore conspiracy case on the grounds of insufficient evidence; whereas Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru were sentenced to death"
7. **Deportation to Cellular Jail, Andaman Islands, and hunger strikes (1933–1937):** Reached the Cellular Jail in Port Blair in January 1933, took part in the 1933 and 1937 Andaman hunger strikes, co-founded the Communist Consolidation study circle, and contracted tuberculosis | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "Batukeshwarr Dutt was awarded a life sentence in the assembly bomb case and was deported to the Andaman Cellular Jail. In the Andamans, Dutt participated in two hunger strikes"
8. **Repatriation to the mainland and release from Bankipur Jail, Patna (1937–8 September 1938):** Brought back from the Andamans in 1937 and released on medical grounds from Bankipur Central Jail in Patna on 8 September 1938 | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "transferred from Andaman jail in 1937 to Hazaribagh jail, Delhi jail and finally to the Patna jail, ultimately being released on September 8, 1938"
9. **Quit India Movement arrest and four-year imprisonment (1942–1945/1947):** Joined Mahatma Gandhi's Quit India Movement in 1942 and was imprisoned in Motihari and Muzaffarpur jails in Bihar, followed by house arrest in Patna and Deoghar | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "He nonetheless participated in the Quit India Movement of Mahatma Gandhi and was again jailed for four years. He was lodged in Motihari Jail"

10. **Final illness in Patna and New Delhi and cremation at Hussainiwala (November 1964–July 1965):** After struggling to get a hospital bed in Patna in 1964, he was flown to Delhi's Safdarjung Hospital on 22 November 1964, treated at AIIMS where Bhagat Singh's mother Vidyavati Devi stayed by his side, died on 20 July 1965, and was cremated at Hussainiwala | The Wire (July 2020) | > "He arrived at Delhi's Safdarjung Hospital on November 22, 1964... Dutt breathed his last on July 20, 1965. He was laid to rest next to his comrades Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru at Hussainiwala"

2. Story angles (at least 10)

Angle 1: Watching a Child Beaten on Kanpur's Prohibited Mall Road

- **Title:** The Road Where Indian Children Could Not Walk
- **One-line hook:** As a teenager in Kanpur, Batukeshwar watched a British man beat an Indian child simply for wandering onto a street reserved for Europeans—and decided that day to join the freedom struggle.
- **Key facts:**
  - In his early teens in Kanpur, Dutt saw a British subject beat an Indian child who had stepped onto the Mall Road | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "The journey of Batukeshwar Dutt as a revolutionary activist began in his early teenage years, after witnessing the brutal beating of an Indian child at the hands of British subject on the Mall road in Kanpur."
  - Indians were barred from walking on that stretch of road | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "The child had wandered on the road which was prohibited for Indians."
  - Soon after, through *Pratap* editor Sureshchandra Bhattacharya, Dutt met revolutionary organiser Sachindranath Sanyal | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "Through Sureshchandra Bhattacharya, who was an editor at Pratap, Dutt came in contact with the revolutionaries like Sachindranath Sanyal"

Angle 2: Holding Lanterns by the Flooded Ganges with Teenage Bhagat Singh

- **Title:** Two Boys with Lanterns by the Dark River
- **One-line hook:** When the Ganges River flooded Kanpur in 1924, 13-year-old Batukeshwar and 16-year-old Bhagat Singh stood together all night holding lanterns to rescue people swept away by the water.
- **Key facts:**
  - Dutt and Bhagat Singh first met in Kanpur in 1924 when both were teenagers | Batukeshwar Dutt Biography | > "In 1924, in Kanpur, Batukeshwar Dutt met Bhagat Singh. Dutt was thirteen or fourteen; Singh was about sixteen."
  - During the 1924 Kanpur floods, both boys volunteered with a youth rescue group called Tarun Sangh | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "When Kanpur was flooded in 1924, both Singh and Dutt volunteered to be a part of 'Tarun Sangh'- formed to help the flood victims."
  - In Dutt's own later written account (PERSONAL MEMORY by Batukeshwar Dutt), they stood side by side at night along the Ganges holding lanterns for swimmers trying to reach shore | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "“Both of us stood by the side of Ganga in night, holding Lanterns so that, somebody who went into the stream made an attempt to reach

the shore could be saved ..."""
    - Dutt also taught Bhagat Singh the Bengali language and recited poems by Kazi Nazrul Islam to him | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "Dutt also helped Bhagat Singh learn Bengali and introduced him to the poetry of Kazi Nazirul Islam, which he would often sing."

Angle 3: The Secret Tunnel in Oari Village

- **Title:** Hiding Bhagat Singh in a Bengal Village Tunnel
- **One-line hook:** When British police across India were hunting for Bhagat Singh in late 1928, Batukeshwar brought his disguised friend home to his quiet Bengal village and hid with him in an underground tunnel.
- **Key facts:**
    - After the December 1928 shooting of police officer J. P. Saunders in Lahore, Bhagat Singh disguised himself in a long coat and hat and traveled to Calcutta, where he met Dutt | Liberation | > "Bhagat Singh shed his Sardar look and reached Calcutta in a long coat and hat. There he once again met Batukeshwar Dutt."
    - Dutt took Bhagat Singh to his ancestral village of Oari (Oadi) in Burdwan district, where they hid until police heard of their presence | Liberation | > "Dutt took him to his ancestral village Oadi where both stayed for some time, but the police got wind of their whereabouts and they went underground. The tunnel in which they hid is present to this day"

Angle 4: Smoke, Red Leaflets, and Standing Still in the Assembly

- **Title:** "To Make the Deaf Hear"
- **One-line hook:** On 8 April 1929, Batukeshwar and Bhagat Singh threw two small smoke bombs onto empty benches in Delhi's parliament, rained down red paper leaflets, and stood completely still waiting for the police.
- **Key facts:**
    - On 8 April 1929, just as Assembly President Vithalbhai Patel rose to give his ruling on the Public Safety Bill, Singh and Dutt threw two bombs from the Visitors' Gallery | The Tribune (Jan 2025) | > "The bombs were thrown just after the Assembly had passed the Trade Disputes Bill and the President of the Assembly, Vithalbhai Patel, had risen to give his ruling on the Public Safety Bill."
    - According to the Chief Inspector of Explosives, the bombs were cast-iron shells weighing 3.5 to 4 ounces (about 100 grams), aimed at empty spaces so no one would be killed | The Tribune (Jan 2025) | > "the Chief Inspector of Explosives would testify that the bombs were made of cast iron, weighed 3.5 to 4 ounces (about 100 gram)" and Wikipedia: Hindustan Socialist Republican Association | > "Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt threw bombs at the empty benches, being careful to ensure that there were no casualties"
    - They showered leaflets signed "Balraj" that began with the words *"It takes a loud noise to make the deaf hear"*, shouted *"Inquilab Zindabad!"*, and stayed where they were to be arrested | The Tribune (Jan 2025) | > "'It takes a loud noise to make the deaf hear,' said the pamphlet referring to French anarchists and justifying the bomb."

Angle 5: The Class 9 Delhi Boys Wearing Batukeshwar Dutt Buttons

- **Title:** The Secret Police Report on Ninth-Grade Jacket Buttons
- **One-line hook:** In 1930, British secret police in Delhi wrote an urgent report to the Deputy Commissioner because ninth-grade schoolboys were coming to class wearing tiny buttons with Batukeshwar Dutt's and Bhagat Singh's faces on them.
- **Key facts:**
  - On 5 November 1930, the Superintendent of Police, CID, Delhi, sent an official letter to J. N. G. Johnson, Deputy Commissioner of Delhi, about students at M. B. High School | The Tribune (Aug 2026) | > "The letter, accessed by PTI, was written on November 5, 1930, by the then superintendent of police, Criminal Investigation Department (CID), Delhi, to JNG Johnson, ICS, Deputy Commissioner of Delhi, about activities at M B High School."
  - The CID officer reported that Class 9 boys were wearing buttons showing pictures of Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt, and that photographs of revolutionary leaders had been hung inside classrooms | The Tribune (Aug 2026) | > "pictures of revolutionaries Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt appeared on schoolchildren's buttons, while political photographs found space inside classrooms too... It drew attention to Class 9 boys"

Angle 6: The Autograph in Bhagat Singh's Prison Diary and the Last Letter

- **Title:** The Signature in the Prison Diary
- **One-line hook:** On the day British guards separated Batukeshwar and Bhagat Singh forever at Lahore Central Jail, Bhagat Singh pulled out his notebook to ask for his friend's autograph—and later wrote to his mother that Batukeshwar carried a piece of him.
- **Key facts:**
  - On 16 July 1930, when Dutt was transferred from Lahore Central Jail to Multan Jail, Bhagat Singh took Dutt's signature in his prison diary before they parted | Liberation | > "On 16 July 1930 the atmosphere in Lahore Central Jail was gloomy. On that day Batukeshwar Dutt was to be sent from Lahore Central Jail to Multan Jail... Bhagat Singh took out his diary and took Batukehwar's signature in it."
  - After the Lahore Conspiracy Case death verdict in October 1930, Bhagat Singh wrote a letter to Dutt telling him that surviving life imprisonment required as much courage as the gallows | Liberation | > "I will die, but you will remain alive to bear the punishment of life imprisonment, and it is my firm belief that you will prove that a revolutionary can gladly suffer lifelong torture"
  - In a letter to his mother Vidyavati Devi, Bhagat Singh wrote that he was leaving part of himself behind in Dutt | Liberation | > "In a letter to his mother Bhagat Singh wrote, "I am going, but in Batukehwar Dutt I am leaving behind a part of myself"."

Angle 7: The Handwritten Magazine *The Call* Inside Cellular Jail

- **Title:** The Secret Prison Magazine on the Island of Black Waters
- **One-line hook:** Locked inside an island prison in the Andaman Sea, Batukeshwar and his fellow prisoners went on a 46-day hunger strike to win the right to read books and control their own kitchen—then wrote a magazine by hand inside their cells.
- **Key facts:**
  - Sent to the Cellular Jail ("Kala Pani") in the Andaman Islands in January 1933, Dutt and

fellow prisoners launched a 46-day hunger strike in 1933 during which three prisoners—including Mahavir Singh—died from forced nasal feeding of milk | Liberation | > "10-12 people flung Mahavir Singh down on the ground, thrust a pipe down his nose and forcibly poured milk into it... After 46 days the demands of the prisoners were met"
    - After winning access to books, newspapers, letters, and control of the prison kitchen, Dutt and about 35 prisoners formed a study circle called the Communist Consolidation | Liberation | > "The authorities acceded to demands for improvement in meals, better lighting, facility to send and receive letters... Control of the kitchen also came into the prisoners' hands."
    - Inside the prison, Dutt wrote for a handwritten magazine titled *The Call*, edited by fellow prisoner Jaidev Kapoor | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "Dutt also used to write the handwritten magazine titled 'The Call', for the study circle which was edited by Jaidev Kapoor."

Angle 8: Selling Biscuits in Patna and Being Asked to "Prove" Who He Was

- **Title:** "Prove You Were a Freedom Fighter"
- **One-line hook:** Years after India became free, Batukeshwar was so poor he sold biscuits and cigarettes in Patna—and when he applied for a bus permit, a government officer demanded paper proof that he was really Batukeshwar Dutt.
- **Key facts:**
    - Living in Jakkanpur, Patna, after independence with damaged health and no pension, Dutt worked as a cigarette company agent, sold bread and biscuits, and sometimes worked as a tourist guide while his wife Anjali taught school | The Wire (July 2020) | > "This is why a revolutionary like Batukeshwar Dutt had to work as a cigarette company agent, shuttling between Patna's tobacco shops, or sell biscuits and bread for a living."
    - When Dutt met the commissioner in Patna to apply for a bus service permit, the official asked him to produce proof of his identity as a freedom fighter | The Wire (July 2020) | > "Once, when he met the commissioner in Patna in the process of obtaining a permit to start a bus service, the commissioner sought proof of identity from him."
    - When President Dr. Rajendra Prasad heard what had happened, he expressed regret and the commissioner apologised to Dutt | The Wire (July 2020) | > "When the then President of India, Dr Rajendra Prasad, learned of this incident, he expressed his personal regrets and the commissioner apologised."

Angle 9: Returning to Bhagat Singh's Village After 33 Years

- **Title:** The Day Khatkar Kalan Welcomed Its Other Son
- **One-line hook:** Thirty-three years after Bhagat Singh was hanged, Batukeshwar visited Bhagat Singh's home village in Punjab for the first time, where villagers garlanded him with flowers and Bhagat Singh's elderly mother wept in his arms.
- **Key facts:**
    - When Dutt visited Bhagat Singh's ancestral village of Khatkar Kalan in Punjab, villagers greeted him with flower garlands | Wikimedia Commons: File:People garlanding Batukeshswar Dutt.jpg | > "People garlanding Batukeshswar Dutt on his arrival at Khatkar Kalan, where he met Shaheed Bhagat Singh's mother Vidyavati Devi at their ancestral

house, first time since Singh's execution."
    - Bhagat Singh's mother, Vidyavati Devi, embraced Dutt and treated his wife and daughter as her own family | Liberation | > "Mother Vidyavati Devi embraced Dutt and kept crying as though she was meeting Bhagat Singh himself. Vidyavati Devi adopted Batukeshwar Dutt's family as her own"

Angle 10: What Happened After—85-Year-Old Vidyavati Devi at His Hospital Bed and His Last Wish

- **Title:** One Last Wish: "Lay Me Next to My Friend"
- **One-line hook:** When Batukeshwar lay dying in a Delhi hospital in 1965, Bhagat Singh's 85-year-old mother sat by his bed holding his head in her lap, and Batukeshwar asked the Chief Minister of Punjab for just one thing: to be cremated beside Bhagat Singh.
- **Key facts:**
    - In 1964, when a sick Dutt could not get a bed at a government hospital in Patna, his friend Chamanlal Azad wrote an angry letter to the newspapers, prompting the government to fly him to Delhi on 22 November 1964 | The Wire (July 2020) | > "In 1964, when Batukeshwar Dutt fell ill and needed to be admitted to a government hospital in Patna, he could not find a bed... He arrived at Delhi's Safdarjung Hospital on November 22, 1964"
    - While Dutt was treated for cancer at AIIMS in Delhi in 1965, Bhagat Singh's 85-year-old mother Vidyavati Devi stayed by his bedside; actor Manoj Kumar also met Dutt while visiting Vidyavati Devi during the making of the 1965 film *Shaheed*, which Dutt co-wrote | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "He was frequently visited in the hospital by Bhagat Singh's 85-year-old mother Vidyawati Devi, who had a lot of affection for him; she was with him during his last days." and Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "He was one of the writers of the film Shaheed (1965). During the filming of Shaheed, once the lead actor Manoj Kumar went to meet Bhagat Singh's mother... Kumar said that he met Dutt there."
    - When the Chief Minister of Punjab visited Dutt in the hospital and offered financial help, Dutt asked only to be cremated at Hussainiwala beside Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru | The Wire (July 2020) | > "When the then chief minister of Punjab visited Batukeshwar Dutt in hospital and offered him financial aid, Dutt made only one request – to be cremated where his friend Bhagat Singh had been cremated."

Which angle is the big "flagship" story, and why

Angle 4 ("To Make the Deaf Hear") paired with Angle 8 ("Prove You Were a Freedom Fighter") and Angle 10 ("Lay Me Next to My Friend") is the flagship story. Most 10-year-old readers know Bhagat Singh threw a bomb in the Assembly, but almost none know there was a 18-year-old partner standing right beside him who survived the Andaman Islands, went back to prison during the Quit India Movement, sold biscuits in Patna to feed his family, and asked at the end of his life to be laid to rest beside his boyhood friend at Hussainiwala.

3. People and places connected

People

- **Goshtha Bihari Dutt (Dutta) & Kamini Devi:** Batukeshwar Dutt's father and mother.

- **Vishveshwar Dutt:** Batukeshwar Dutt's brother in Jakkanpur, Patna, with whom he lived after his 1938 release.
- **Anjali Dutt:** Batukeshwar Dutt's wife, who worked as a schoolteacher in Patna and supported the household.
- **Bharati Dutta Bagchi:** The only daughter of Batukeshwar and Anjali Dutt, who lived in Patna.
- **Bhagat Singh:** Revolutionary comrade whom Dutt met in Kanpur in 1924, hid in Oari village in 1928, and joined in the 8 April 1929 Central Legislative Assembly bombing and prison hunger strike.
- **Vidyavati Devi:** Bhagat Singh's mother, who welcomed Dutt at Khatkar Kalan and stayed beside his hospital bed in Delhi in 1965 when she was 85 years old.
- **Chandra Shekhar Azad ("Balraj"):** Commander-in-chief of the HSRA who signed the red Assembly leaflets as "Balraj".
- **Sachindra Nath Sanyal:** Co-founder of the Hindustan Republican Association in Kanpur in 1924 who recruited young Dutt and later served time in the Cellular Jail.
- **Sukhdev Thapar & Shivaram Rajguru:** Fellow HSRA revolutionaries executed alongside Bhagat Singh on 23 March 1931 and cremated at Hussainiwala, where Dutt was later cremated.
- **Jatindra Nath Das (Yatindranath Das):** Fellow revolutionary who died on 13 September 1929 on the 63rd day of the Lahore jail hunger strike after forced nasal feeding.
- **Mahavir Singh, Mohit Mitra, & Mohan Kishore:** Three political prisoners who died during the 1933 hunger strike in the Andaman Cellular Jail.
- **Vijay Kumar Sinha, Jaidev Kapoor, Shiv Verma, & Ajoy Ghosh:** Kanpur schoolmates and HSRA comrades who were tried with Dutt or imprisoned alongside him in the Andaman Cellular Jail.
- **Vithalbhai Patel:** President (Speaker) of the Central Legislative Assembly who was about to deliver his ruling on the Public Safety Bill when the bombs were thrown on 8 April 1929.
- **Sir George Schuster & Sir Bomanji Dalal:** Finance member and official seated near where the bombs fell in the Assembly on 8 April 1929.
- **Asaf Ali:** Defence lawyer who represented Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt in the Delhi Assembly Bomb Case and read their joint statement in court on 6 June 1929.
- **Dr. Rajendra Prasad:** Congress leader in Bihar and later first President of India, who visited an ailing Dutt in jail in 1938 and later apologised when a Patna commissioner asked Dutt to prove his identity.
- **Chamanlal Azad:** Fellow freedom fighter whose 1964 letter to newspapers revealed that a dying Batukeshwar Dutt could not get a hospital bed in Patna.
- **Manoj Kumar:** Actor and filmmaker who credited Dutt as a co-writer on the 1965 film *Shaheed* and met him while visiting Bhagat Singh's mother.

Groups and Events

- **Hindustan Republican Association (HRA) / Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA):** Revolutionary organisation founded in 1924 and reorganised under a socialist name in 1928, to which Dutt belonged.

- **Central Legislative Assembly Bombing (8 April 1929):** Protest in which Singh and Dutt threw two small bombs and leaflets against the Public Safety Bill and Trade Disputes Bill.
- **1929 Lahore Jail Hunger Strike:** Fast by Dutt, Bhagat Singh, and Lahore Conspiracy prisoners demanding political prisoner status.
- **Communist Consolidation:** Study circle formed by Dutt and about 35 fellow prisoners inside the Andaman Cellular Jail in the 1930s.
- **Quit India Movement (1942):** Mass independence campaign led by Mahatma Gandhi, during which Dutt was arrested and jailed in Bihar.

Places

- **Oari (Onari / Oadi), Khandaghosh, Purba Bardhaman, West Bengal:** Ancestral Bengal village where Dutt was born in 1910 and where he hid Bhagat Singh in late 1928.
- **Kanpur (Cawnpore), Uttar Pradesh:** Industrial city where Dutt grew up, went to school at Theosophical High School and Pandit Prithi Nath High School, and met Bhagat Singh in 1924.
- **Central Legislative Assembly (now Samvidhan Sadan / Old Parliament House), New Delhi:** Chamber where Singh and Dutt threw two bombs and red leaflets on 8 April 1929.
- **Lahore Central Jail, Multan Jail, & Salem Central Jail:** Prisons where Dutt was held between 1929 and 1933 before his deportation to the Andamans.
- **Cellular Jail ("Kala Pani"), Port Blair, Andaman and Nicobar Islands:** Island prison where Dutt served his life sentence from 1933 to 1937 and contracted tuberculosis.
- **Bankipur Central Jail, Motihari Jail, & Muzaffarpur Jail (Bihar):** Prisons in Bihar where Dutt was held before his September 1938 release and again during the 1942 Quit India Movement.
- **Jakkanpur, Patna, Bihar:** Neighbourhood where Dutt lived with his wife Anjali and daughter Bharati after independence.
- **Khatkar Kalan, Punjab:** Bhagat Singh's ancestral village, where villagers garlanded Dutt on his post-independence visit to meet Vidyavati Devi.
- **Safdarjung Hospital, AIIMS, & B. K. Dutt Colony, New Delhi:** Hospitals where Dutt was treated in 1964–1965 and the nearby New Delhi residential colony named after him.
- **Hussainiwala, near Firozpur, Punjab:** Memorial site on the Sutlej River bank near the India–Pakistan border where Dutt was cremated on 21 July 1965 beside Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, and Rajguru.

4. Disputes, legends and doubts

1. Year and place of birth (18 November 1910 in Oari, Bengal vs. 18 November 1911 vs. Kanpur)

- **Version A (18 November 1910 in Oari / Onari village, Khandaghosh, Burdwan, Bengal):** Wikipedia, *The Wire*, and *batukeshwardutt.com* state he was born on 18 November 1910 in Oari (Onari), Khandaghosh, Burdwan district, Bengal | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "He was born on 18 November 1910 in Onari, Khandaghosh village, Purba Bardhaman district, in what is now West Bengal"
- **Version B (18 November 1911 in Oadi village, Burdwan):** *Liberation* gives his birth date

as 18 November 1911 | Liberation | > "Batukeshwar Dutt's family was from Oadi village in Khandaghosh Thana, Burdwan District, West Bengal. He was born on 18 November 1911."
- **Version C (18 November 1910 in Kanpur):** The Wikimedia Commons / Wikidata infobox lists Kanpur (where he grew up) as his place of birth | Wikimedia Commons: Category:Batukeshwar Dutt | > "Date of birth: 18 November 1910, Kanpur"

2. Who was originally chosen by the HSRA to throw the Assembly bombs?

- **Version A (Originally Batukeshwar Dutt and Sukhdev Thapar, while Bhagat Singh went to the USSR):** Wikipedia states the HSRA first decided that Dutt and Sukhdev would throw the bombs while Bhagat Singh traveled to the Soviet Union, before changing the plan to Bhagat Singh and Dutt | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "Initially, it was decided that Dutt and Sukhdev Thapar would plant the bomb while Singh would travel to the USSR. However, later the plan was changed and Dutt was entrusted with planting it alongside Singh."
- **Version B (Originally Bhagat Singh and Sukhdev, until Dutt demanded to be included):** *Liberation* states that Bhagat Singh and Sukhdev were suggested first, causing Dutt to protest and demand to be included | Liberation | > "The names of Bhagat Singh and Sukhdev were suggested for this job. The usually calm Batukeshwar erupted in anger at this. He demanded to be included in this as one of the oldest comrades"

3. Year of marriage to Anjali Dutt (1937 vs. November 1947)

- **Version A (November 1947, after Indian independence):** Wikipedia and *batukeshwardutt.com* state that Dutt married Anjali in November 1947 after India gained independence | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "After India gained independence, he married Anjali in November 1947."
- **Version B (1937, upon release from the Andaman Jail):** *The Wire* (Nov 2020) states he married Anjali Dutt in 1937 upon his release from the Andaman Jail | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "He married Anjali Dutt in 1937 upon his release from the Andaman Jail, and had a daughter Bharati Bagachi."

4. Duration of the 1929 prison hunger strike (63 days vs. 114 days)

- **Version A (63 days):** Wikipedia and *batukeshwardutt.com* state that Dutt and Singh's 1929 hunger strike lasted 63 days (matching the 63-day fast of Jatindra Nath Das, who died on 13 September 1929) | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "The hunger strike lasted for 63 days, during which time Dutt and Singh were subjected to brutal treatment by the prison authorities."
- **Version B (114 days):** *The Wire* (Nov 2020) states the strike ran for 114 days (counting from 15 June 1929 until the strike was called off in October 1929) | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "In jail, B.K. Dutt and Bhagat Singh started one of the longest ever hunger strikes in modern political history. The strike, which ran for 114 days, was meant to demand better living condition"

5. Year the HRA was renamed the Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (1927 vs. September 1928)

- **Version A (8–9 September 1928 at Feroz Shah Kotla, Delhi):** Wikipedia's HSRA article, *Liberation*, and *batukeshwardutt.com* state the name change took place in September 1928 at Feroz Shah Kotla in Delhi | Wikipedia: Hindustan Socialist Republican Association | > "These groups and the HRA met at Feroz Shah Kotla, in Delhi, on 8–9 September 1928, and from this emerged the HSRA."
- **Version B (1927):** *The Wire* (Nov 2020) places the renaming in 1927 | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "In 1927, its name was changed to Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA), identifying socialism as one of the primary goals"

6. Service in the Bihar Legislative Council (Four months vs. one year vs. unconfirmed)

- **Version A (Four months):** *The Wire* (Nov 2020) states he served on the Bihar Legislative Council for four months | The Wire (Nov 2020) | > "He was appointed as a member of the legislative council in Bihar, but that too only for four months."
- **Version B (One year in 1963):** *Liberation* states he was nominated to the Bihar Legislative Council in 1963 for one year | Liberation | > "In 1963 he was nominated to the Bihar Legislative Council for one year but he never availed himself of any benefits"
- **Version C (Flagged as unconfirmed by biographical project):** *batukeshwardutt.com* notes the claim is reported in secondary accounts but flags it as not independently confirmed in primary records | Batukeshwar Dutt Biography | > "Some accounts state that he was later nominated to the Bihar Legislative Council, and that his return to formal politics was brief. This site flags that claim as reported rather than independently confirmed"

7. Fictional / Literary Error About Dutt Dying in the 1929 Hunger Strike

- **FICTIONAL ERROR (1989 novel *Gopallapurathu Makkal* by Ki. Rajanarayanan):** In the 1989 Tamil novel *Gopallapurathu Makkal*, Dutt is mistakenly described as dying on the 56th day of his 1929 hunger strike (confusing his survival with the death of hunger striker Jatindra Nath Das), when in reality Dutt lived until 20 July 1965 | Wikipedia: Batukeshwar Dutt | > "In Ki. Rajanarayanan's novel Gopallapurathu makkal (1989), Dutt is anachronistically mentioned as dead on the 56th day of his hunger-strike in 1929."

5. Pictures

All links below are Wikimedia Commons file pages that were opened and verified as public domain or Creative Commons licensed:

1. **Portrait of Batukeshwar Dutt (c. 1929):** File:Batukeshwar dutt.jpg | Studio portrait photograph of young Batukeshwar Dutt | **Date:** Uploaded 10 November 2012 (historical 1929 portrait) | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright").
2. **Official Logo of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Army:** File:Official Logo of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Army.jpg | Emblem/logo of the Hindustan Socialist Republican Army (HSRA), sourced from the Indian Culture Portal | **Date:** Before 1960 (uploaded 21 November 2021) | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for

copyright") and structured data Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International.

3. **Hunger Strike Poster of Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt:** File:Hunger strike poster of Bhagat Singh and Batukeshswar Dutt.jpg | Archival poster from the Punjab State Archives showing portraits of Bhagat Singh and Batukeshwar Dutt during their prison hunger strike | **Date:** Uploaded 1 September 2021 (original poster from 1929–1930s in Punjab State Archives) | **Licence as stated on page:** Creative Commons Attribution-Share Alike 4.0 International (CC BY-SA 4.0).
4. **Front Page of *The Tribune* Reporting the Execution of Dutt's Comrades (25 March 1931):** File:Bhagat Singh's execution Lahore Tribune Front page.jpg | Front page of *The Tribune* (Lahore) dated 25 March 1931 with the headline *"BHAGAT SINGH, RAJGURU AND SUKHDEV EXECUTED"* | **Date:** 25 March 1931 | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("Front page of the Lahore Tribune in 1931 - therefore copyright has expired and image is now in Public domain" under Indian and Pakistani copyright law).
5. **People Garlanding Batukeshwar Dutt at Khatkar Kalan:** File:People garlanding Batukeshswar Dutt.jpg | Photograph from the Punjab State Archives showing villagers putting flower garlands around Batukeshwar Dutt on his arrival at Bhagat Singh's ancestral village of Khatkar Kalan to meet Vidyavati Devi | **Date:** Listed as "before 1960" on the file page (historically dated to his post-independence visit) | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright") and structured data Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International.
6. **Batukeshwar Dutt in Hospital with His Wife Anjali and Daughter Bharati (1965):** File:Batukeshswar Dutt on his death bed. His wife Anjali and daughter, Bharati are standing.jpg | Photograph from the Punjab State Archives showing Batukeshwar Dutt lying in his hospital bed while his wife Anjali and daughter Bharati stand beside him | **Date:** Listed as "before 1960" on the file page (depicts his 1964–1965 hospitalisation) | **Licence as stated on page:** Public domain ("This work is in the public domain in India because its term of copyright has expired or it is ineligible for copyright") and structured data Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International.

6. Sources used

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2. How revolutionaries roused the masses — *The Tribune* (by historian M. Rajivlochan).
3. In the court of public opinion (Excerpt from *Revolutionaries On Trial: Sedition, Betrayal and Martyrdom* by historian Aparna Vaidik) — *Mint* (Hindustan Times Group / Aleph Book Company).
4. Remembering Batukeshwar Dutt: Bhagat Singh's Fellow Revolutionary, Forgotten in Life and Death — *The Wire* (drawing on Anil Verma's National Book Trust biography *Batukeshwar Dutt – Bhagat Singh ke Sahyogi*).
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scholars Ankur Goswami and Harshvardhan).
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13. File:Hunger strike poster of Bhagat Singh and Batukeshswar Dutt.jpg — Wikimedia Commons.
14. File:Bhagat Singh's execution Lahore Tribune Front page.jpg — Wikimedia Commons.
15. File:People garlanding Batukeshswar Dutt.jpg — Wikimedia Commons.
16. File:Batukeshswar Dutt on his death bed. His wife Anjali and daughter, Bharati are standing.jpg — Wikimedia Commons.